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Ridgeline HD front strut top-mount bearing failure causing clunk and uneven t

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1 Condition

Affected Ridgeline HD vehicles may produce a clunk or grinding noise from the front suspension during low-speed turns, originating from the front strut assembly STRT-8500. In some cases the related wheel hub bearing WHB-8580 contributes a droning noise that rises with road speed, along with uneven or feathered tire wear. Both symptoms may be present together because a failing top-mount bearing alters camber and loads the hub bearing abnormally. For component identification, see Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Assembly .

2 Cause

The primary cause is premature wear of the top-mount bearing integrated into front strut assembly STRT-8500, which binds and then develops play under load. The induced misalignment accelerates wear of the wheel hub bearing WHB-8580, so both parts should be inspected when either symptom is present. Confirm bearing condition by feeling for roughness while rotating the hub and by checking strut bearing rotation. Detailed inspection criteria for the hub appear in Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Wheel Hub Bearing Assembly .

3 Repair Procedure

Replace front strut assembly STRT-8500 following PROC-STRUT, observing all spring-compression safety precautions and torque specifications during reassembly. If the wheel hub bearing WHB-8580 exhibits play or noise, replace it following PROC-HUB-BEARING and verify final running clearance. The strut replacement steps are documented in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Front Strut Replacement Procedure , and the hub bearing steps in the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Wheel Hub Bearing Replacement Procedure . After repair, perform a four-wheel alignment and verify the noise is eliminated on a road test; see the Ridgeline HD Suspension Service Manual :: Suspension System Overview for general system notes.